

Gothic Revival

Following the Renaissance, the Gothic style had been ridiculed and generally considered ugly, thanks in no small part to painter and architect Giorgio Vasari (1511–74). He had labelled medieval architecture 'Gothic,' declaring that the Goths had invented it after sacking Rome. But by the 1830s, several architects were re-evaluating church architecture: they saw Gothic as truly Christian, and dismissed classicism and neoclassicism as 'pagan'. Devout Catholic Augustus Welby Northmore Pugin (1812–52) argued that a return to the medieval styles of architecture would lead to the revival of a morally upright Christian society. John Ruskin (1819–1900), a leading art critic and patron, draughtsman, watercolourist and philanthropist, wrote *The Seven Lamps of Architecture* (1849) and *The Stones of Venice* (1851–3), promoting the virtues of a Protestant form of Gothic architecture. The third significant theorist of the Gothic Revival was the French architect Eugène Emmanuel Viollet-le-Duc, who had become known for his restorations of medieval buildings.



Budapest Parliament Building, Imre Steindl, 1885–1904